

How ethical is monitoring?

Every worker has a right to protest against employers monitoring his/her e-mail and Internet use. Well, in the UK at least, if not in India.

UK's information commission has passed a draft, which makes monitoring of employee e-mail usage illegal. That ought to make many employees happy. After all, would you like it if someone

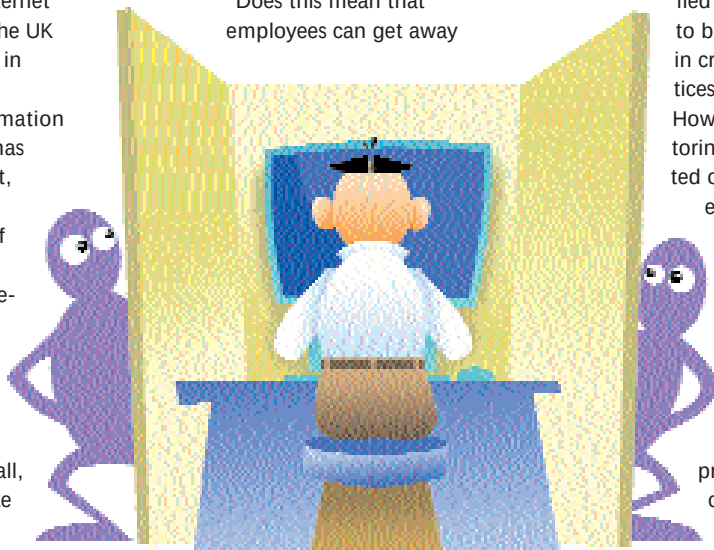
else read your snail mail letters before it reached you? Why should e-mail be different?

Does this mean that employees can get away

with anything? Not exactly. Monitoring of staff is permitted if the management has identi-

fied an employee to be indulging in criminal practices on the Net. However, monitoring is permitted only to gather evidence.

Although the draft has several loopholes, it is a welcome measure for most privacy advocates.



Move over, Graffiti and Transcribe

"You have a meeting scheduled with the boss at 10." No, that's not your secretary. That's your PDA speaking.

PDA manufacturers like HP and IBM are already working on speech for the PDA. These devices can recognise speech, translate it into other languages, and announce the translation. While they're at it, a talking PDA called Phraselator is already out there. And it's being used by US troops in Afghanistan!

Phraselator will actually translate commands and



phrases in English to Urdu. Its database has more than 1,000 phrases in different languages. It even uses specific tones for each kind of phrase. More phrases are being added to enhance its power.

Tux with MS Office

Linux lovers hate to admit this, but there are times when they miss MS Office. That's when software like CrossOver Office step in.

CodeWeavers has released a new software called CrossOver Office which lets you run MS Office and Lotus Notes on Linux. CrossOver Office does not need a Windows licence. Nor does it need emulators like WINE. Till now, one of the major problems faced when running Windows applications on Linux was the need to run emulators, which basically lead to applications being slower.

CrossOver Office is priced at approximately Rs 2,750 and is an attractive proposition for Office fans who have crossed over to Linux.

Fly DSL class

What would you give to surf on DSL

speeds while you are flying?

Well, Inmarsat's Swift64 will offer satellite bandwidth for aeroplanes to help passengers surf, send e-mail and even watch TV.

Swift64 offers data speeds of up to 64 kbps, same as that of a DSL connection. It will be available for corporate jet owners in June and for commercial airlines by the end of 2002.

The technology makes use of communications antennas that are already

using Inmarsat's services.

Passengers will connect their laptops to an onboard Internet server via an Internet jack available at each seat.

The Internet server will be using Inmarsat's communication antennas to transmit and receive data.



snapshot

The use of home PCs for surfing has dropped by almost **40%** (in the last four years) because people are surfing more at work

Source: www.ucsi.cc

■ Tetris goes pay-per-play in UK ■ Microsoft to officially support CD+RW standard ■ Groove's upcoming software seeks to revolutionise P2P